making. Governance practices are emerging in response to risk and operational needs.

In most cases, the challenge is not knowing where to start. It's how to move forward thoughtfully without causing unnecessary disruptions. The best approach is to build on what already exists, beginning with a single, clear access problem that is already causing visible friction for employees, customers, or partners. This might be a document-sharing rule, a partner API permission, or an internal approval workflow that is hard to change or explain. Externalizing that decision into a shared policy service provides immediate value while developing skills, establishing patterns, and creating practices that can be reused elsewhere.

Instead of trying a complete redesign, organizations should focus on targeted improvements that address urgent needs while also enhancing the underlying decision-making infrastructure. Throughout these efforts, a consistent set of practices emerges:

- Make authorization decisions observable.
- Externalize a meaningful policy domain by moving a coherent set of related decisions (such as document sharing or API access) into a shared set of policies.
- Unify policy language and evaluation.
- Invest in the governance of signals and delegation.
- Design systems assuming that authorization decisions will be made at runtime.

These are not phases to finish in sequence, but practices to adopt and revisit as systems evolve. Each step reduces inconsistency, enhances visibility, and expands the ability to manage delegation and context more deliberately.

Table 19.1 shows common situations and corresponding next steps. These examples illustrate how the practices given above can be used in real-world scenarios. They are not a checklist; they are practical actions organizations can take depending on their current situation. Most teams will recognize multiple rows that are relevant to their current state.